Draft - expert review pending

This unit is complete and passes the platform's automated checks, but no reviewer has read it yet. Treat its sources and claims with care.

Draft translation - not yet human-reviewed / مسودہ ترجمہ

Foundations of Functional English

This unit builds the foundation on which the rest of the course rests. Before you can communicate effectively, read with understanding, or write with clarity, you need command of the building blocks: words, the rules that govern them, the structures that hold them together, and the sounds that carry them. This unit gives you that foundation.

Unit learning outcomes

By the end of this unit you should be able to:

- Explain how **vocabulary** functions in context, including register, collocation, and connotation.
- Identify and correct common **grammatical** errors in written and spoken English.
- Describe the main **word-formation** processes (affixation, compounding, clipping, back formation) and apply them to unfamiliar words.
- Distinguish the four main **sentence structures** (simple, compound, complex, compound-complex) and explain how structure affects meaning.
- Identify the key features of the English **sound system** that differ from Urdu and apply strategies to improve pronunciation.

Prerequisite knowledge

No prior course is assumed. The unit starts from the level of a student who has completed intermediate education in Pakistan and uses English as a second or additional language.

In this unit

1. Topic 1.1 - Words in context: vocabulary and grammar - vocabulary in context, communicative grammar, and common errors.
2. Topic 1.2 - Building words and sentences - word-formation processes and sentence structures.
3. Topic 1.3 - Sounds of English - the English sound system and pronunciation challenges for Urdu speakers.

How to use this unit

The three topics build on each other. Topic 1.1 gives you the vocabulary and grammar you need to understand the examples in Topics 1.2 and 1.3. Work through them in order, and use the glossary terms (marked with underlining) as your reference points throughout the course.

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